

Dax Whitney, RHP, Oregon State

Metrics

FB: 97.1/18.7 IVB/2.2 HB/-4.69 VAA/6.38 relH/6.54 ext/55.1 AA/50.5% zone/55.2% usage/2400 rpm

CT: 88.6/5.1 IVB/-8.3 HB/-7.11 VAA/47.7 AA/50.0% zone/2.9% usage/2480 rpm

CB: 76.9/-17.3 IVB/-12.1 HB/-10.74 VAA/61.4 AA/36.5% zone/7.1% usage/2730 rpm

SL: 85.6/-2.2 IVB/-13.4 HB/-8.49 VAA/51.6 AA/42.9% zone/23.1% usage/2710 rpm

CH: 87.7/4.0 IVB/12.3 HB/-7.68 VAA/46.0 AA/31.7% zone/11.7% usage/1400 rpm

Write-Up

Whitney possesses one of the most complete arsenals and best overall pitch quality profiles in the dataset. The combination of a power fastball, two legitimate bat-missing secondaries, and advanced strike-throwing ability allowed him to dominate hitters throughout the season. More importantly, he generated swing-and-miss in multiple ways, giving him several avenues to navigate lineups and maintain effectiveness deep into games. The profile already resembles that of a professional starter and offers one of the higher ceilings among the arms evaluated.

The FB is a legitimate weapon. Averaging 97.1 mph while touching triple digits, the pitch pairs premium velocity with nearly 19 inches of IVB and a quality -4.69° VAA. The resulting shape creates consistent swing-and-miss at the top of the strike zone, producing a 36.3% whiff rate and 35.6% CSW despite being thrown more than half the time. Whitney demonstrated confidence attacking hitters aggressively in all counts and consistently generated poor contact when opponents did connect. The combination of velocity, carry, extension, and results supports a plus-plus projection. 65/70 pitch.

The CB serves as a distinct change-of-pace offering and creates extreme vertical separation from the fastball. The shape is impressive, featuring over 17 inches of depth and substantial sweep. While the usage is relatively limited, the pitch generated quality swing-and-miss and gives Whitney another way to disrupt timing. The command remains inconsistent, but the raw shape projects comfortably. 50/55 pitch.

The SL is the best secondary in the arsenal. Featuring over 13 inches of gloveside movement and strong velocity, the pitch generated a 56.8% whiff rate, 24.4% SwStr rate, and 51.7% CSW. The pitch consistently functioned as the primary put-away offering against right-handed hitters and flashed the ability to miss bats both inside and outside the strike zone. Professional hitters may adjust to portions of the arsenal, but the slider already projects as a genuine out pitch. 65/70 pitch.

The CH rounds out the repertoire and may be the most underrated pitch in the mix. The pitch generated a 56.9% whiff rate and 31.7% SwStr rate while consistently missing barrels against opposite-handed hitters. Whitney demonstrated comfort throwing the pitch in leverage counts and generated substantial chase beneath the zone. The combination of velocity separation, movement, and results gives the pitch above-average professional projection. 55/60 pitch.